



AUREA HOSTING

ADELAIDE · SOUTH AUSTRALIA

The Adelaide Short-Stay Yield Report

2026 Annual Edition

A field guide to occupancy, pricing, and demand patterns
in Adelaide's short-term rental market.

PUBLISHED BY AUREA HOSTING

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Why we publish this

This report is for Adelaide property owners weighing short-term rental as an investment strategy, and for existing hosts wondering whether their numbers match the market.

Every figure cited here comes from public sources — AirDNA, Airbtics, AirROI, STR, the South Australian Tourism Commission, and published festival impact reports. No proprietary or contractual data has been disclosed. Where sources disagree, we publish the range and explain the disagreement rather than smoothing it into a single number.

The interpretation layer — what the data means for your property, what to do about it — is ours. That's the value Aurea adds. The numbers anyone can look up. Knowing which ones matter, and what they imply for a 2-bedroom in Glenelg versus a Hills retreat, is the operator's job.

— *Noah Rebuli, Aurea Hosting*

The market at a glance

The Adelaide short-term rental market in 2025–2026 is best described as **rewarding execution, punishing complacency**.

- 01 The market is growing, but so is supply.** Adelaide added roughly 57% more Airbnb listings over the past year. Revenue and nightly rates still trended upward — demand is absorbing the new inventory — but owners on static pricing and generic management are losing ground.
- 02 Occupancy figures you see online range wildly** (48% to 72%). Both numbers are correct, depending on how the source defines "active listing" and whether they include dormant hosts. Expect a well-managed Adelaide property to fall in the 60–72% range across a full year.
- 03 Nightly rates cluster around \$180–\$240 ADR**, with the top 10% of listings commanding \$370+. The premium is rarely explained by property alone — it's execution, pricing discipline, and positioning.
- 04 Adelaide's event calendar is unusually concentrated and unusually profitable.** Fringe (Feb–Mar), Gather Round (April), and Tour Down Under (January) combined drive over 775,000 visitor nights per year. Properties priced statically during these windows are leaving 30–60% revenue on the table.
- 05 Winter (June–August) is weaker than most owners realise.** The typical Adelaide property sees occupancy dip 15–20 points in winter. Operators who accept this and plan for it outperform those who don't.
- 06 Booking lead times average 59 days.** Owners who set prices quarterly or annually are pricing against demand data that's two months stale.

The Adelaide market in numbers

Active listings

Adelaide had approximately **3,472 active short-term rental listings** tracked by AirROI across April 2025 – March 2026, up from roughly 2,200 the year prior — a **56.7% year-on-year supply increase**. This is significant growth, but still smaller than Sydney (+28.9%) or Brisbane (+34.0%) in absolute terms.

Nightly rates (ADR)

Source	Adelaide ADR	Notes
AirROI (Apr 2025 – Mar 2026)	\$212	Market-wide average across all active listings
AirDNA MarketMinder	\$180	Includes inactive/underperforming listings
Airbtics (Feb 2025 – Jan 2026)	\$240	Excludes dormant listings; reflects active hosts only

Interpretation: the \$180 figure represents market reality including underperformers. The \$240 figure represents what a well-managed property actually charges. The gap between the two — roughly 33% — is the premium a serious operator can command. That's not opinion; that's what the data says about the spread between average and top-quartile performance.

Occupancy

Source	Adelaide occupancy
AirROI (2026 data)	48.1%
AirDNA MarketMinder	59%
Airbtics	72%
Hometime (2025 FY)	72%

Same story, different definitions. The low-end figures include every listing, active or not. The high-end figures reflect properties that are genuinely available and managed. **For a well-managed Adelaide property, 60–72% occupancy is the realistic range.** Anything below 60% is an execution problem, not a market problem.

Annual revenue

Per listing, across the full year:

- Bottom quartile: under \$20,000
- Market median: \$22,500 – \$31,000 (depending on source)
- Top quartile: \$45,000 – \$65,000
- Top 10%: \$80,000+

These ranges hide more than they reveal. A 1-bedroom CBD apartment and a 4-bedroom Glenelg beach house are not the same business. Property-type segmentation matters more than city-wide averages.

The seasonal rhythm

Adelaide's short-stay demand follows a predictable but often misunderstood pattern.

The peaks

- **February–March** (Fringe + Festival + WOMADelaide + Adelaide 500) — colloquially "Mad March." Hotel occupancy hits 87–93% during this window; short-stay rates lift 30–50% above annual average.
- **April** (Gather Round + school holidays) — emerging as the new secondary peak. In 2025 the Friday of Gather Round set Adelaide's all-time hotel occupancy record at 93%.
- **Mid-January** (Tour Down Under) — 807,900 attendees across the state in 2025. A nine-day occupancy spike on top of what's already the summer holiday period.
- **May** (Tasting Australia) — less dramatic than March, but a meaningful shoulder-season lift that many owners miss.

The troughs

- **June–August** — Adelaide's winter. Occupancy drops 15–20 percentage points. Rates need to drop to maintain bookings; the alternative is empty weeks.
- **Late November** — a surprising pre-Christmas lull as business travel winds down but holiday travel hasn't begun.

What this means operationally. The gap between peak and trough for an Adelaide property is wider than most owners price for. A property charging \$220/night all year might command \$340 during Fringe and need to drop to \$140 in winter to hold 50% occupancy. Static pricing systematically under-earns in peak months and over-prices in trough months. The daily revenue loss isn't dramatic; the annual loss compounds into thousands.

The event calendar effect

Three events dominate Adelaide's tourism calendar. Each has a measurable short-stay impact.

Adelaide Fringe (February – March)

Duration: 31 days · **2025 economic impact:** \$197.7M expenditure, \$144.2M new money · **Visitor nights:** 306,318 in 2024 · **Typical stay:** ~7 nights · **Rate effect:** 30–50% uplift on annual ADR

Fringe is a month-long event, not a weekend spike. Owners who price it as a weekend event miss 3+ weeks of premium pricing opportunity.

AFL Gather Round (April)

Duration: 4 days · **2025 economic impact:** \$113.9M · **Visitor nights:** 241,613 (+26% YoY) · **Interstate visitors:** 54,000+ · **Rate effect:** 40–80% uplift event-week, esp. near Adelaide Oval, Norwood Oval, Barossa Park

Gather Round is the fastest-growing demand event on the Adelaide calendar. Supply tightens dramatically in the weeks before — hotels hit 93% average occupancy. Short-stay properties that release inventory early at appropriate prices capture the overflow.

Santos Tour Down Under (January)

Duration: 9 days · **2025 economic impact:** \$98M expenditure, \$62.5M value added · **Attendance:** 807,900 · **Rate effect:** 20–40% uplift, varies by stage-route proximity

TDU is geographically diffuse — stages move through the Hills, Barossa, and coastal regions each day. Properties near stage finishes see event-specific spikes; city properties see a steady general lift.

Secondary events worth pricing for

- **Tasting Australia** (May): 10-day food and wine festival, moderate lift
- **WOMAdelaide** (March, overlaps with Fringe)
- **LIV Golf Adelaide** (February): 3-day international golf event with luxury international visitation
- **Adelaide 500 / Adelaide Motorsport Festival** (February/March)
- **School holiday periods:** 4 per year, 2-week windows, driving domestic family demand

Suburb notes

City-wide averages obscure the fact that Adelaide's short-stay market is really several sub-markets operating side by side. Two we manage closely — and have strong views on.

Glenelg and Henley Beach

WHO STAYS HERE

Families, couples, and groups in town for summer holidays and major events. Lower business-travel weighting than the CBD; higher holiday-maker intent.

WHAT PERFORMS

Large family homes — four-plus bedrooms, outdoor space, room to move — outperform smaller apartments on revenue per available night. Guests coming to the beach want beach-appropriate accommodation, not a hotel substitute.

DEMAND PATTERN

Concentrated around summer (December–February), Tour Down Under (stage routes pass through the coast), and LIV Golf (international visitation that skews toward premium beachfront product). The shoulder seasons hold up better here than in the CBD because the beach itself is the drawcard.

Norwood and the Eastern Suburbs

WHO STAYS HERE

Families, professionals, and footy fans. A distinctly different guest persona from the CBD — people who want the best of Adelaide without being CBD-locked.

WHAT PERFORMS

Three to four-bedroom homes, clean and minimalist in their finish, and distinctly *not* rundown. The eastern suburbs guest expects a home that matches the neighbourhood's standard.

DEMAND PATTERN

The most balanced year-round performer of any Adelaide suburb cluster we track. Fringe and Gather Round both drive meaningful demand — Norwood Oval's role as a Gather Round venue makes this one of the biggest April upswings in the city.

What this means for your property

Five principles Aurea has learned managing Adelaide short-stays for over five years.

1. Price daily, not quarterly.

The booking lead time in Adelaide averages 59 days. If you set prices on the 1st of each month, you're pricing against demand signals that are already two months old. The spread between a dynamically-priced property and a statically-priced one of equivalent quality is typically 10–20% of annual revenue.

2. Treat the event calendar as your pricing backbone.

Fringe, Gather Round, and TDU are not "bonus periods." They're structural features of the Adelaide market that deserve their own pricing strategy months in advance. Release inventory with premium pricing 90+ days before each event; the early-bird buyers pay the most.

3. Accept winter.

Adelaide winters are real. Properties that drop rates 15–25% between June and August to preserve occupancy outperform properties that hold firm and sit empty. Empty nights earn zero; discounted nights earn something, and often lead to repeat bookings in warmer months.

4. Respond in minutes, not hours.

Airbnb's algorithm weights response time heavily. Guests remember slow hosts. Every marginal review score improvement compounds through the algorithm into more visibility and more bookings at higher prices. This is a management discipline, not a technology problem.

5. Segment your property correctly.

A beachside 2-bedroom and a Hills retreat and a CBD studio are three different businesses with three different guest personas, three different event sensitivities, and three different optimum pricing strategies. Applying a single strategy across different property types is the most common way owners leave money on the table.

About Aurea Hosting

Aurea is Adelaide's selective short-stay asset manager. We take on a small cohort of properties each quarter and manage them personally — pricing, listing, guest communication, turnovers, and performance reporting.

Our founder, Noah Rebuli, has managed 20+ Adelaide properties across more than five years in the industry before launching Aurea. The report you're reading is one small reflection of what that experience teaches about this market.

Currently accepting 5–6 properties for Q2 2026.

Work with us, or stay in the loop.

If you're an Adelaide owner considering a change of manager — or considering short-stay for the first time — we'd welcome the conversation.

APPLY TO WORK WITH US aureahosting.com.au/contact

FUTURE EDITIONS & QUARTERLY NOTES aureahosting.com.au/report

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Methodology

Market data: AirDNA MarketMinder (public tier), AirROI public data, Airbtics Australian market report 2025, Hometime Adelaide market report 2026.

Event data: Adelaide Fringe Impact Report 2025, South Australian Tourism Commission media releases, AFL Gather Round independent economic evaluation (IER, 2025), Santos Tour Down Under economic analysis (Deloitte Access Economics, 2025).

Suburb observations: Aurea Hosting operator experience across 20+ Adelaide properties, 2020–2026.

Nothing in this report should be read as financial or investment advice. Property-specific performance varies widely; consult a qualified advisor for decisions about your specific asset.

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